

Willard Robinson

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Education

North Carolina State University , Ph.D. Economics	2027 (expected)
Committee: Spencer Banzhaf (advisor), Erin Sills , Roger von Haefen , Zhenxuan Wang	
Montana State University , M.S. Applied Economics	2022
Appalachian State University , B.A. Economics (<i>summa cum laude</i>)	2020
Minor: Mathematics	

Research fields

Fields: Environmental and natural resource economics, environmental markets, nonmarket valuation

Working papers

<i>Asymmetric Information and Transaction Costs in Voluntary Conservation Markets</i> (Job market paper)	[Link]
<i>Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California</i>	[Link]
• Under review • First place, <i>William D. Toussaint Best Paper Award</i>, NC State Economics Department	

Works in progress

<i>Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act</i>	
<i>The Value of Shoreline Recreational Fishing Across Time and Space: An internal meta-regression approach</i> (with Sasha Naumenko , Colton Leach , and Roger von Haefen)	
<i>Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment: Evidence from NCSU Engineering</i> (with Umut Dur)	
<i>Recreation Welfare Effects with Climate Change-Induced Migration</i>	

Research experience

CEnREP Graduate research assistant , (Environmental policy) with Spencer Banzhaf	Jan 2024–present
Graduate research assistant (Matching theory) with Umut Dur	Jan. 2025–Jan. 2026
Graduate research assistant (Agricultural policy) with Nick Hagerty	Aug 2020–May 2022
Research assistant (Non-market valuation) with John Whitehead	June 2019–May 2020
Research assistant (Experimental economics) with Brock Stoddard	June 2019–May 2020

Teaching experience

Ph.D. = Doctorate course, *U.* = Undergraduate course

Instructor

ARE 336 (<i>U.</i>): Introduction to Environmental and Resource Economics; <i>Fall '25</i>	NC State University
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ECNS 202 (U.): Principles of Macroeconomics; *Fall '21, Spring '22*

Montana State
University

Graduate teaching assistant

ARE 336 (U.): Introduction to Environmental and Resource
Economics; *Fall '23, Spring '25*

NC State University

ECG 702 (Ph.D.): Microeconomic Theory II; *Spring '24*

EC 201 (U.): Principles of Microeconomics; *Fall '22, Spring '22, Fall '23 (Head TA)*

ECNS 202 (U.): Principles of Macroeconomics; *Summer '21, Summer '22*

Montana State
University

ECNS 403R (U.): Introductory Econometrics; *Fall '20*

Seminars and conference presentations (including scheduled*)

Asymmetric Information and Transaction Costs in Voluntary Conservation Markets

Camp Resources XXXII (2026), AERE @ the Southern Economic Association* (2026), Appalachian State University* (2026), East Carolina University* (2026), North Carolina State University (2026)

Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California

NCSU Economics Third Year Workshop (2026)

Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act

Property and Environment Research Center (2025), Appalachian Experimental and Environmental Workshop (2024)

Recreation Welfare Effects with Climate Change-Induced Migration

NCSU Graduate Student Seminar Series (2025)

Awards and fellowships

Andrew J. & Thelma K. Bartley Endowed Graduate Fellowship, Poole
College of Management

2026

NBER travel grant

2026

First place, Best Paper Award, Department of Economics

2026

PERC graduate summer fellowship, **Property and Environment
Research Center**

2025

Top student in economics, Appalachian State University

2020

Professional activities

Referee service

AERE @ the Southern Economic Association conference, Environmental Research Letters

University service

Graduate student seminar organizer, NCSU

2025–present

Vice President, Economics Graduate Student Association, NCSU

2024–present

Membership

American Economic Association

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists

European Association of Environmental Resource Economists

Technical skills

Computing: Julia, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Matlab, R, SAS, Stata

References

Spencer Banzhaf

Professor

North Carolina State University

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Roger von Haefen

Professor

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Zhenxuan Wang

Assistant Professor

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